

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: It's time to request some funding!



Day of the Zombie Reimbursement Requests

Learning Outcome

Describe the reasons or results of events or actions in spoken or written texts, in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever asked a boss to pay for your expenses? Explain.
- When should an employee ask for funding to attend an event?

Can Do Statements

- I can write to request or report about the purpose of events or actions related to job issues.
- I can express willingness or intention to do something in work and job issues in a written way.
- I can write a funding request letter.





Let's Explore!

Adam wants to attend an upcoming conference. He has been told that he needs to send a formal letter, asking for funding.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Date: January 14th

Dear Ms. Moore,

I would like to attend the upcoming Teach With Us conference in Chicago, Illinois, on February 1st.

The conference theme is Teaching in the 21st Century and it is the premier event for teaching professionals. This year's conference centers on digital teaching resources and using other online methods, which are pertinent to what we are publishing right now. The conference also features many world-renowned publishers and motivational talks that would be of great benefit to my work. In addition, workshops will include discussions with best-selling authors and consultants on the front lines of the publishing industry.

The networking I will do with the conference attendees will prove invaluable. It will give me the opportunity to get out of the office and meet colleagues from around the world! It is the perfect place to learn what others in our industry are doing and how they're doing it. I would also like to organize a private consultation with a senior executive from PubWorld in order to discuss the design of our upcoming projects spearheaded by Lincoln Green. They are highly regarded for redefining magazine layouts, as seen at the recent unveiling of Cosmalian Magazine. The website detailing the conference can be found at www.epublica.cam. I have been following the live stream so as to keep up to date with planned events. There is considerable buzz about the conference! The cost for attending the conference is significant. Over and above the cost of the registration fee, there are also travel expenses. These will include flights, hotel, and meals. I would also hope to attend the dinner so as to network as much as possible. The total cost for the conference is \$2100 USD. An itemized account is listed below.

Conference Fee: \$250

Gala Dinner Event: \$250

Airfare: \$800 return

Hotel: \$500

Meals: \$300

Total : \$2100

I am confident you will agree that this investment is worthwhile. I will be networking with the industry's best and will attend invaluable educational sessions. I would be able to meet and share ideas with colleagues from around the world. Further, I will use this opportunity for the betterment of the company.

Sincerely,

Adam Bari





Let's Practice!

Adam is planning on being extremely busy during the conference.

Instructions: Underline the incorrect word in the sentence. Write the correct one on the lines.

1. I will be network with the industry's best and will attend invaluable educational sessions.

2. I would be able to meet and share ideas with colleague from around the world.

3. My attendance at this conference will be a wise invest as I will use this opportunity for the betterment of the company.

4. I would like to organize a private consult with a senior executive from PubWorld.

5. The networking I will do with conference attendance will prove invaluable.



Let's Practice!

Adam has a plan and a purpose.

Instructions: Use the words from the box to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

unveiling / for redefining / in order to / spearheaded / so as to /
for attending / so as to keep up

1. I would like to organize a private consultation _____ discuss our upcoming design projects _____ by Lincoln Green.
2. The cost _____ the conference is significant.
3. I have been following the conference Twitter stream epublica@bigsky _____ to date with planned events.
4. I also wish to attend the evening after the dinner speaker and motivational keynote speaker _____ network as much as possible.
5. They are highly-regarded _____ magazine layouts, as seen at the recent _____ of Cosmalian Magazine.



Extension Activity

Time to find an ideal conference destination!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and research the most exciting and spectacular conference locations in the world.
- Estimate the cost of travel, accommodation and meals for a 3-day conference.
- Write a letter to your boss asking for funding to attend the event. Be persuasive!
- Describe what will be happening during the 3 days and explain how your attending will benefit the company.
- Use a formal greeting and closing.
- Proofread your letter.
- Read your letter aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research an ideal location for a work conference.

☐
☐

I estimate the cost to attend the event.

☐
☐

I write a letter asking for funding.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **premier** (adjective): most important or best
e.g. The conference theme is Teaching in the 21st Century and it is the premier event for teaching professionals.
- **digital** (adjective): related to using computer technology
e.g. This year's conference centers on digital teaching resources and using other online methods.
- **consultant** (noun): a person who provides services or advice to organizations for a fee
e.g. In addition, workshops will include discussions with best-selling authors and consultants on the front lines of the publishing industry.
- **invaluable** (adjective): extremely valuable or useful
e.g. The networking I will do with the conference attendants will prove invaluable.
- **to spearhead** (verb): a person, thing, or group that organizes or leads something
e.g. I want to discuss our upcoming design projects spearheaded by Lincoln Green.
- **to unveil** (verb): to show or reveal (something) to others for the first time
e.g. They are highly regarded for redefining magazine layouts, as seen at the recent unveiling of Cosmopolitan Magazine.
- **betterment** (noun): the act or result of making something better
e.g. I will use this opportunity for the betterment of the company.





Learning Points

Purpose Clauses: *in order to* and *so as to*

There are a variety of ways to express purpose. The most common way is to use an infinitive of purpose (to + verb). You can use other phrases and expressions to introduce a purpose clause. Varying the structures you use when you are speaking or writing can be beneficial in making you appear more professional.

You can use the phrases *in order to* and *so as to* to introduce the reason for actions or situations.

In order to

This is a formal way of presenting the reason for something.

For example:

*I called a meeting **in order to** discuss funding for the conference.*

You can choose to use **so as to** as well.

This is another formal phrase you can use to introduce a reason clause.

For example:

*I am attending the conference **so as to** network with other like-minded people.*

You often use *in order to* and *so as to* after stative verbs like *know*, *seem* and *appear*.

For example:

*He dressed in a dark suit at the meeting **in order to/so as to** appear more serious.*

Examples:

- *I am networking so as to meet new people in my field.*
- *I am attending the seminar in order to learn more about the product.*
- *We are meeting the client in order to get some more information about their concerns.*
- *They are leaving now so as not to be late.*





Learning Points

How to Write a Funding Request Letter

You may have an opportunity to attend conferences during your career. You can write a request letter for funding to pay for the trip. It may cover the cost of meals, accommodation, flights and associated fees.

A strong letter that provides detailed information about the conference and the benefits of your attendance for you and your company is essential.

They should include a formal greeting and closing.

State how attending the conference will benefit the company.

Examples:

- *As you learn more, you do more. Your skill set will be enhanced.*
- *Advancement from within. The company may be able to hire internally in the future.*
- *Your new skills will make you more productive at work.*
- *You will be able to take on additional assignments.*
- *You will be able to increase your leadership skills and take on more responsibility.*

